



Once Upon a Deadpool...

Is essentially a kid-friendly version of Deadpool 2 that makes it PG 13 by omitting curses and gore. <https://digit.in/dec18-62-1>



Pokemon Let's Go breaks records

Pokemon Lets Go Pikachu and Eevee shatters first week sales record for the Switch with 3 million copies sold. <https://digit.in/dec18-62-2>

Foldable Phones Suck

Boo Man tells us why foldable phones raise his blood pressure

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Y

ay! It's 2000 all over again and the foldable phones are here! Such futuristic sci-fi stuff, right? So

original, so new, so... boring! Don't you love the artificial hype people and companies build around silly features that promise to be the biggest thing ever, and then fizzle out eventually?

Don't get me wrong, foldable phones look awesome in science fiction. They're also really functional, and are actually foldable! What we have right now is so far behind fiction, that it's not even the same thing at all! For starters FFFs (fictional foldable fones – I wanted that alliteration, so sue me) are sleek, disposable and can be printed on any surface we want. You can roll them, fold, crumple and crush them and they still work, because that's what foldable screens should do, and how they should work.

What we have now, however, is something just trying to cash in on novelty instead of functionality. You can bet there will be hefty price tags on these things, and for what? Just to show off to a couple of friends for a few days? Watch them snigger when you accidentally drop and break it...

So are there no positives? Well, maybe because of the larger size we might finally get rid of that stupid notch that seems to be the norm these days. You know what having a foldable display means though, right? The bezels are back! Seems like only yesterday

we were all headed towards nice sleek phones that didn't have those ugly bezels, and smartphones might be thrust back in time 10 years just like that!

You can also bet that the screen resolution on the "cover display" is going to be reduced. Want to bet that's the display you use most often to check messages, social media updates and more? Sure, there are use case scenarios where resolution doesn't matter as much, such as when reading text (720p is pretty legible), but there are other things you do as well... such as using social media or just surfing the web, and you don't always need the large screen for that.



A foldable phone seen in the movie Ultraviolet

The large, wide screen format is ideal for video content and games. By that I mean two handed operation in landscape mode. That's not the way you want to be surfing the web or Instagram... especially not with the thick-as-a-brick look that the new phones are going to have.

How do you protect a phone like this? Usually companies like Corning and Asahi make strong glass to prevent shattering of screens or scratches, but glass doesn't fold, so this display will have to have some other protective

covering. Not just that, what do you think a case for such a phone is going to look like? It's certainly not going to protect the inside screens!

If that's not all, look at the dying tablet market. No one really wants them anymore, despite them being more powerful and having more battery life than your phone.

Battery life is another issue. Effectively you have to power three displays, and that's going to swallow battery juice in a jiffy. Then there's the processor and RAM requirements to power a larger display (which will presumably have more pixels to light and control).

It doesn't matter if the technology is ready or not, every manufacturer is going to hop on the bandwagon with gusto and make you fund their slow R&D efforts towards actual foldable displays. Samsung, LG, Motorola, Lenovo, Huawei, Xiaomi and Apple are all rumoured to be working on foldable phones.

I'm not a fan of being used in this way, to fill the pockets of companies who are much more interested in marketing you half-baked features as revolutionary, instead of actually innovating. Are you? 